American Century Investments®

Small Cap Value Fund

Quarterly Commentary

Portfolio Review

Small caps broadly finished the quarter lower. The third quarter presented a challenging environment for small-cap stocks as uncertainty surrounding the conflict in Iran and oil prices led to persistent inflation concerns. The Federal Reserve hiked its benchmark interest rate in September, which further weighed on investor sentiment as small-cap equities broadly lagged large caps.

Value outperformed growth across the market-capitalization spectrum. Through periods of market volatility, equity markets shifted in the quarter as investors weighed the resilience of corporate earnings and economic growth against expectations for higher inflation and rising interest rates. From a style perspective, value stocks took lead and performed better than growth stocks.

Health care positioning weighed on relative performance. The portfolio's underweight exposure to the health care sector relative to the benchmark detracted from returns as a few key benchmark constituents in the medical equipment and biotechnology industries had very strong results.

Materials holdings were a source of weakness. Our choice of investments in the materials sector detracted as uneven demand and company-specific execution issues occurred among several of our positions. Within the construction materials industry, Suncrete and Titan America notably weighed on relative performance.

Stock selection within the real estate sector contributed. Selective real estate investment trust holdings outperformed as positioning in health care properties helped differentiate results. A lack of exposure to underperforming benchmark names across the sector was also beneficial.

Key Contributors

Accelerant Holdings. The company announced a definitive agreement to be acquired and taken private. We believe this highlighted the strategic value of its data-driven specialty insurance marketplace and supported Accelerant's shares during the period.

NIQ Global Intelligence. Shares surged higher in August following the company's strong quarterly earnings report. Investors responded favorably to the value of the company's consumer data platform and the potential for analytics demand to support durable growth.

Crescent Energy. The stock rallied during the quarter as we believe Crescent's disciplined operations, scale benefits and constructive oil and gas dynamics supported investors' expectations for free cash flow.

Key Detractors

Cardinal Infrastructure Group. Shares of Cardinal declined after the company reported results that raised concerns about its near-term execution and profitability.

Entravision Communications. Uncertainty around advertising trends and the durability of recent growth weighed on investor sentiment toward Entravision's media platform, causing its stock to trade lower during the period.

Goal and Strategy

Long-term capital growth and income by investing in the stocks of small-sized companies that are believed to be undervalued.

Portfolio Management Team

	Start Date	
Name	Industry	Company
Jeff John, CFA	1991	2008
Ryan Cope, CFA	2009	2009

Top 10 Holdings (%)

SOUTHSTATE BANK CORP	2.58
Axis Capital Holdings Ltd	2.52
EVERTEC Inc	2.48
Brink's Co/The	2.30
Home BancShares Inc/AR	2.24
EquipmentShare.com Inc	2.05
Chord Energy Corp	2.04
Old National Bancorp/IN	1.98
Edgewell Personal Care Co	1.95
UMB Financial Corp	1.93

As of 9/30/2026

The holdings listed should not be considered recommendations to purchase or sell a particular security. Equity holdings are grouped to include common shares, depository receipts, rights and warrants issued by the same company. Fund holdings subject to change.

Bath & Body Works. Company shares slid during the quarter as investors remained cautious about consumer spending and the pace of merchandise margin improvement.

Notable Trades

ADI Global Distribution. This company distributes security, audiovisual, fire safety and low-voltage smart living technologies. We initiated a position as we believe its scaled security products network, recurring installer relationships and margin improvement potential create an attractive value opportunity.

Morningstar. We initiated a position in Morningstar, recognizing what we believe is value in its trusted investment data, research and recurring subscription businesses.

MarineMax. We exited the position after the terms of its announced acquisition by Safe Harbor substantially realized our investment thesis and limited potential upside, in our view.

Accelerant Holdings. We decided to exit the position as the announced plans to go private via an acquisition brought Accelerant's shares closer to what we believed was their fair value.

Portfolio Positioning

The portfolio seeks to invest in small-cap companies where we believe the valuation does not reflect the quality and normal earnings power of the company. Our process is based on individual security selection, but broad themes have emerged.

Increased overweight in industrials. Our overweight exposure to the sector relative to the benchmark has been driven by what we believe are attractive individual stock-specific opportunities in the electrical equipment, machinery and professional services industries. Our research has indicated that these companies have been able to exert strong pricing power during the recent inflationary environment. This pricing power, coupled with strong intrinsic unit demand and prudent cost control efforts, has led to significant excess cash flow. We've also seen companies accelerating their efforts to return value to shareholders via increased dividends, share buybacks and debt reduction.

Maintained overweight position in energy. Our overweight allocation to the energy sector relative to the benchmark remained mostly steady from the start of the quarter. Within the sector, our overweight exposure is primarily attributable to the oil, gas and consumable fuels industry. We believe our positioning favors service businesses with less direct oil and gas sensitivity and production-linked exposure and conservatively managed exploration and production companies with strong capital allocation track records.

Financials exposure was reduced. While we maintain an overweight position in financials relative to the benchmark, we decreased the portfolio's exposure to the sector. We reduced our position in banking, which is now underweight compared to the benchmark. We also increased our exposure to capital markets, bringing it to an overweight versus the benchmark.

No exposure to utilities. We currently hold no positions in this sector. Much of the recent periods of strength seen in utilities can be attributed to more nontraditional power-related names in the benchmark universe that were swept up as artificial intelligence-related power plays, none of which we believed aligned with our view of quality investments in the space. Although we continue to look for opportunities to gain exposure in this sector, we believe we have found better risk/reward opportunities in more cyclical corners of the market.

Few opportunities in health care. We continue to be significantly underweight in health care relative to the benchmark as we believe sector valuations have generally not presented attractive risk/reward opportunities. A significant portion of our underweight continues to be driven by our lack of exposure to small-cap biotechnology, pharmaceuticals and life sciences tools and services companies. As a group, we believe many of these companies do not offer the strong cash flow, high returns or attractive valuation characteristics that we generally seek. We will likely remain materially underweight in health care as those industry groups now account for a significant portion of the benchmark.

Small Cap Value Fund

TICKERS Investor Class: ASVIX	I Class: ACVIX	A Class: ACSCX	C Class: ASVNX	R Class: ASVRX	R5 Class: ASVGX	R6 Class: ASVDX

Data presented reflects past performance. Past performance is no guarantee of future results. Current performance may be higher or lower than the performance shown. To obtain performance data current to the most recent month end, please visit www.americancentury.com/performance. Investment return and share value will fluctuate, and redemption value may be more or less than original cost. Data assumes reinvestment of dividends and capital gains. Returns for periods less than one year are not annualized. For information about other share classes available, please consult the prospectus. There is no guarantee that the investment objectives will be met. Dividends and yields represent past performance and there is no guarantee that they will continue to be paid.

Average Annual Total Returns for Period Ended 9/30/2026

Class	Qtr (%)	1 Year (%)	3 Year (%)	5 Year (%)	10 Year (%)	Since Inception (%)	Inception Date	Gross Expense Ratio (%)
Investor	-6.42	11.12	10.04	4.27	9.10	10.44	7/31/98	1.10
I	-6.27	11.45	10.29	4.49	9.33	10.89	10/26/98	0.90
R5	-6.27	11.44	10.28	4.48	9.33	8.15	4/10/17	0.90
R6	-6.24	11.50	10.45	4.64	9.49	8.99	7/26/13	0.75
Russell 2000 Value Index	-4.91	20.77	17.93	7.80	9.40	-	-	-

Historical performance for the R5 Class prior to its inception is based on the performance of I Class shares, which have the same expenses as the R5 Class.

Pre-inception differences in R5 Class and I Class performance are based on rounding.

Expense ratio is as of the fund's current prospectus. The I Class minimum investment amount is $5 million ($3 million for endowments and foundations) per fund. The R5 Share Class is available only to participants in group employer-sponsored retirement plans where a financial intermediary provides recordkeeping services to plan participants.

Periods greater than one year have been annualized.

You should consider the fund's investment objectives, risks, and charges and expenses carefully before you invest. The fund's prospectus or summary prospectus, which can be obtained at americancentury.com, contains this and other information about the fund, and should be read carefully before investing.

The opinions expressed are those of the portfolio investment team and are no guarantee of the future performance of any American Century Investments portfolio. Statements regarding specific holdings represent personal views and compensation has not been received in connection with such views. This information is for an educational purpose only and is not intended to serve as investment advice.

The information is not intended as a personalized recommendation or fiduciary advice and should not be relied upon for investment, accounting, legal or tax advice.

Historically, small- and/or mid-cap stocks have been more volatile than the stocks of larger, more established companies. Smaller companies may have limited resources, product lines and markets, and their securities may trade less frequently and in more limited volumes than those of larger companies.

The Russell 2000® Index measures the performance of the small-cap segment of the U.S. equity universe. The Russell 2000® Value Index measures the performance of those Russell 2000® companies with lower price-to-book ratios and lower forecasted growth values. Created by Frank Russell Company, it is not an investment product available for purchase.

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